

General Interview Instructions:

- Be respectful: Be professional and courteous to everyone.
- Make sure to show your positive attitude during the interview.
- When answering questions, always remember not to talk for an excessively long time. Make sure you give concise and precise answers.
- If you don't understand any questions during an interview, you should ask the interviewer for clarification, instead of giving the wrong answer.
- Never interrupt the interviewer in between and stop if he starts speaking. Never argue.

Introduction

Good Morning Sir, my name is Aman Tripathi, and I am currently pursuing BTech in Information Technology from IIIT, Gwalior. I have a strong foundation in software development and cloud computing. I did a summer internship at Tata Consultancy Services in Lucknow, where I led key DevOps initiatives to develop and implement cost-efficient, scalable solutions leveraging AEM Cloud Services, CI/CD pipelines, and auto-scaling technologies.

I have worked on several innovative projects, such as "Echo," a peer-to-peer file-sharing and messaging application that reduced file transfer time by 40%,

"Piper," a real-time messaging app that increased user engagement by 40%.

And an e-commerce platform- "HyperMarket" that significantly improved operational scalability and response time.

I am a member of the Entrepreneurship Cell (E-Cell) of our college.

I also have great passion for sports. I especially, love playing and watching football a lot.

HR Interview Questions And Answers

What are your strengths and weaknesses ?

Strengths:

1. **Strong Problem-Solving Skills:** I have a well-honed ability to break down complex problems and find efficient solutions.
2. **Leadership and Teamwork:** As a member of the E-Cell, I've organized workshops and sessions that enhanced collaboration, team engagement, and leadership skills. Also leading the transition to DevOps methodologies during my internship at Tata Consultancy Services further solidified this ability of mine.
3. **Adaptability and Quick Learning:** I easily adapt to new environments and challenges, and learn from my past experiences.
4. **Attention to Detail:** My experience with projects like peer-to-peer file sharing and messaging apps has taught me the importance of precision, especially when working on scalable solutions and secure systems.

Weaknesses:

1. **Tendency to Overanalyse:** At times, I overanalyse decisions or solutions, which can slow down the pace of my work. I am actively working on trusting my instincts and making timely decisions when necessary.
2. **Delegation:** I sometimes prefer to handle tasks independently, which can cause me to take on more work than necessary. However, I am learning to delegate more effectively and trust my teammates to share responsibilities.
3. **Perfectionism:** I have a tendency to strive for perfection and great detail in my work, which can occasionally lead to spending time on details that may not be critical. I am working on balancing quality with efficiency and recognizing when a task is "good enough."

Tell us about your experience at the internship and what all did you learn while working there, also any difficulty you faced at work and how did you deal with it ?

During my internship at TCS, I worked on critical projects wherein, a DevOps transition for AEM Cloud Service was one of my primary responsibilities, and it resulted in a 99.9% system uptime and a 20% increase in scalability. My role involved utilizing cloud-native technologies like CI/CD pipelines, auto-scaling, and automated security, which gave me hands-on experience in cloud computing and automation. Additionally, I optimized infrastructure costs by 15%, leveraging AEM's usage-based pricing model.

What I Learned:

- **Cloud-Native Technologies:** I became proficient in cloud technologies, specifically setting up CI/CD pipelines to automate testing, integration, and deployment processes.
- **DevOps Practices:** Implementing DevOps practices showed me how to accelerate software delivery cycles while ensuring product quality through continuous integration and delivery.
- **Team Collaboration:** Working with cross-functional teams, I learned how to align diverse skill sets toward a common goal, enhancing the team's development efficiency.
- **Communication:** Effectively communicating complex technical ideas to a non-technical audience was critical. I learned how to break down difficult concepts into simpler terms, which improved overall team engagement and adoption of new tools.
- **Adaptability:** Working in a fast-paced environment, I had to quickly learn new technologies and adapt to the changing demands of the project. This experience improved my flexibility in dynamic work settings.
- **Time Management:** With tight deadlines and project milestones, balancing multiple tasks was crucial. I honed my ability to prioritize critical tasks while maintaining focus on long-term goals.

Challenges I Faced:

One challenge I faced was managing the transition to DevOps where everyone was comfortable with traditional workflows. Some initial resistance arose due to unfamiliarity with automated processes like CI/CD and auto-scaling. To overcome this, I leveraged **communication** skills to explain the long-term benefits of automation and how it would streamline their work.

Why are you interested in this job/ Why you want to join Cisco ?

I am particularly interested in this role at Cisco because it perfectly aligns with my passion. My internship at TCS gave me significant exposure to cloud-native technologies, DevOps practices, and automation. The opportunity to build scalable, responsive, and customer-centric products is something I am deeply motivated by, and Cisco's focus on innovation and operational quality resonates with my career goals.

What excites me the most about this role is the chance to work on Cisco's cloud-based customer portal, which connects all Cisco products under one platform. The combination of front-end and back-end development, alongside cloud services and microservices architecture, aligns perfectly with my technical skills in Java, Python, JavaScript, and my ability to troubleshoot and solve complex issues.

I also appreciate Cisco's emphasis on collaboration and learning. My experience working in cross-functional teams, and collaborating with peers and senior architects has strengthened my teamwork and communication skills. I am eager to contribute to a team that values innovation, creativity, and problem-solving, while also learning from the incredible talent at Cisco.

This role represents the perfect opportunity for me to grow, contribute, and continue my journey of working on impactful projects that deliver real business outcomes for customers.

Where do you see yourself in the next 5 years ?

In the next five years, I envision myself growing into a highly skilled software engineer at Cisco. I aim to become proficient not only in the core programming and development practices but also in advanced cloud infrastructure and microservices, continuously improving my ability to build products that deliver real value to users.

At Cisco, I see myself taking on more leadership responsibilities, contributing to the design and development of critical features that enhance the customer experience. I'm particularly excited about working on large-scale projects where I can leverage my problem-solving skills to tackle complex challenges.

I also see myself contributing to Cisco's broader vision of driving digital transformation and operational excellence for its clients.

Ultimately, I hope to grow into a role where I can lead teams in designing, developing, and deploying advanced solutions while continuing to learn and adapt to the ever-evolving tech landscape. Cisco's culture of innovation and learning aligns with my personal goals, making it the perfect environment to achieve these ambitions.

Would you like to work overtime or odd hours?

I understand that putting extra effort impacts the company's development, so I'm happy. If it means I'm contributing to the company, I'll be glad to contribute.

How do you handle stress, pressure, and anxiety ?

1. **Prioritization and Planning:** When faced with multiple tasks or tight deadlines, I prioritize my workload by breaking projects into smaller, manageable tasks. Creating a clear action plan helps me stay organized and focused, which reduces feelings of overwhelm.

2. **Time Management:** Better time management helps me maintain my energy levels and prevents burnout while ensuring that I stay on track with my tasks.
3. **Open Communication:** I find that discussing challenges with colleagues or mentors can alleviate stress. Whether it's seeking feedback or asking for help, maintaining open lines of communication fosters a supportive environment and helps me feel more grounded during high-pressure situations.
4. **Mindfulness and Relaxation Techniques:** I practice mindfulness techniques, such as deep breathing and meditation, to manage anxiety. Taking a few moments to focus on my breathing can help clear my mind and refocus my thoughts, making it easier to tackle challenges with a calm mindset.
5. **Physical Activity:** Engaging in physical activities, such as playing football, is a great way for me to relieve stress. Exercise helps me clear my mind and return to my work feeling refreshed and energized.

Is there anything that makes you different from other candidates.

1. **Diverse Technical Proficiency**
2. **Problem-Solving Mindset**
3. **Collaboration and Leadership Experience:** Involvement in the E-Cell
4. **Adaptability and Eagerness to Learn**
5. **Customer-Centric Approach:** I understand the importance of delivering solutions that not only meet technical requirements but also enhance the overall customer experience. My focus on user-centric design and functionality aligns well with Cisco's commitment to transforming customer experiences.

Do you have any previous experience of team work and what did you learn from it ?

Yes, I have significant experience with teamwork, particularly during my internship at TCS and as a member of the E-Cell of our college.

In both capacities, I collaborated with diverse teams on various projects, which taught me several valuable lessons:

1. **Communication is Key:** I learned the importance of clear and open communication in ensuring that everyone is aligned on goals and expectations. Regular check-ins and updates helped us stay on track.
2. **Leveraging Diverse Skills:** Working with individuals from different backgrounds and expertise allowed us to leverage each other's strengths, resulting in more innovative solutions and better problem-solving.
3. **Conflict Resolution:** I experienced differing opinions and approaches within the team, which taught me how to navigate conflicts constructively by actively listening and finding common ground.
4. **Shared Responsibility:** I realized that successful teamwork involves a shared sense of responsibility. When each team member takes ownership of their tasks, it contributes to the overall success of the project.
5. **Adaptability:** Collaborating with others taught me to be flexible and adapt to different working styles and perspectives, which is essential in a dynamic team environment.

How do you manage multiple deadlines ?

- **Prioritization:** I start by assessing the urgency and importance of each task.
- **Planning:** I create a detailed timeline or to-do list, breaking down larger projects into smaller, manageable tasks.
- **Time Blocking:** I use time blocking to dedicate specific time slots for each task, allowing me to concentrate fully without distractions.
- **Setting Milestones:** For longer projects, I set interim milestones to monitor progress.
- **Open Communication:** I keep communication lines open with my team and stakeholders. If I foresee any challenges in meeting a deadline, I proactively discuss possible adjustments or ask for assistance.
- **Regular Review:** I regularly review my progress and adjust my plan as needed. This helps me stay on track and ensures that I can adapt to any unexpected changes.

What are your hobbies/ What are you passionate about ?

In my free time, I have a few hobbies that I am passionate about. First and foremost, I enjoy playing football, which not only keeps me physically active but also is a great way to relieve stress and stay connected with friends.

I also have a deep appreciation for music. I love exploring different genres and discovering new artists, as music often inspires creativity and helps me unwind. It's a vital part of my daily routine and often accompanies me while I work on projects or study.

Additionally, I am active on Twitter, where I engage with tech communities, follow industry trends, and share insights related to technology and innovation. This platform allows me to connect with like-minded individuals and stay informed about the latest developments in the world.

Are you willing to relocate or travel ?

I would definitely consider it. If the opportunity given to me is appropriate, rewarding and feasible, I don't think I will have any issues with the relocation or traveling involved.

What do you know about us or our company ?

I am impressed by Cisco's commitment to innovation and its role as a leader in the technology industry. I know that Cisco is not only known for its networking solutions but also for its extensive portfolio that includes cloud services, cybersecurity, and collaboration tools. The company has a strong reputation for driving digital transformation across various sectors, including healthcare, education, and smart cities.

I appreciate that Cisco places a significant emphasis on enhancing the customer experience. Furthermore, I admire Cisco's culture of collaboration, inclusivity, and continuous learning. The company's commitment to creating a positive work environment where employees can thrive and contribute to meaningful projects resonates with my personal values.

I am also aware of Cisco's initiatives in sustainability and social responsibility, which reflect a dedication to not only technological advancement but also to making a positive impact on the global community.

Overall, I see Cisco as an ideal place for me to contribute and grow.

Post Interview Questions:

- Can you describe the work culture within Cisco.
- What opportunities for professional development and growth does Cisco offer for new hires?
- What technologies or tools does the Cisco's Engineering team primarily use? Are there any new technologies you are planning to adopt in the near future?
- What are the key expectations for someone in this role and if I get selected how can I better prepare myself in the time until I join? ← **This is my favourite**
- How does Cisco envision its role in the technology landscape over the coming years?
- Can you share more about the work-life balance at Cisco? How does the company support employees in maintaining a healthy balance?